

Phillip Kesling

Staff Software Engineer — Data Platforms & Internal Systems

Greater Madison Area, WI | Open to Remote

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SUMMARY

Staff software engineer specializing in large-scale data platforms, internal engineering systems, and backend services. Experienced designing platforms that combine APIs, data pipelines, and analytics infrastructure. Proven track record building durable platforms used across large engineering organizations. Known for aligning teams around shared data and system contracts, improving reliability, and turning complex engineering ecosystems into trustworthy platforms.

EXPERIENCE

R&D Engineer, Software 6

Broadcom (VMware by Broadcom) • Remote • Nov 2023 – Sept 2025

- Led data platform, architecture, and analytics development for the Secure Release Platform, a cross-product initiative securing and auditing the software development lifecycle across VMware's product portfolio.
- Designed and built cloud-native internal platforms combining backend services, APIs, data pipelines, and analytics systems supporting compliance, traceability, and executive visibility across software supply chains.
- Developed backend services modeling relationships across SCMs, CI/CD systems, infrastructure, and build pipelines to enable end-to-end release traceability.
- Owned the architecture and reliability of PostgreSQL-backed analytical platforms ensuring data quality and auditability.
- Partnered with engineering, security, and product teams to define shared system and data contracts, align engineering teams, clarify ownership boundaries, and evolve platform capabilities safely over time.

Staff II Engineer

VMware • Hybrid • Aug 2013 – Nov 2023

- Progressed from Senior MTS to Staff II Engineer, serving as a technical leader responsible for architecture and delivery of data platforms, analytics infrastructure, and engineering enablement systems across VMware's R&D organization.
- Designed and delivered scalable data platforms supporting engineering telemetry, KPIs, product usage analytics, and customer lifecycle insights across thousands of engineers and products.
- Architected VMware's internal R&D data warehouse, defining canonical data models, ingestion patterns, Python/SQL transformation layers, and governance practices that enabled scalable self-service analytics for engineering and executive stakeholders.
- Built semantic and analytics layers on top of shared data foundations, enabling consistent reporting and operational insights for leadership and engineering teams.

- Delivered curated, ML-ready datasets and platform capabilities supporting data science teams and experimentation workflows.
- Frequently brought into ambiguous or at-risk initiatives to clarify architecture, stabilize delivery, and align stakeholders across teams with competing priorities.
- Mentored engineers globally, raising systems thinking, technical judgment, and consistency in engineering practices.

R&D Application Development Manager

VMware · On-site · *Jan 2008 – Aug 2013*

- Led design and evolution of large-scale internal engineering platforms supporting VMware's product quality and release lifecycle, used by thousands of engineers.
- Oversaw systems spanning test automation, quality analytics, security scanning, and partner enablement.
- Established early practices around platform ownership, automation, and data-driven visibility that informed later enterprise data initiatives.

MTS – Lead Developer

VMware · On-site · *Apr 2006 – Dec 2007*

- Designed and built automation frameworks and internal tools enabling ISV partners and internal teams to validate integrations with VMware software.
- Developed systems supporting test lifecycle management, results aggregation, and reporting across manual and automated workflows.

Software Engineer, Storage

SGI · Mountain View, CA · On-site · *1998 – 2006*

- Built automation frameworks and tooling for testing, validating, and supporting high-end storage systems integrated with UNIX and Linux platforms.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Core Technologies: Distributed Systems, Data Platforms, Backend Services, APIs, Python, Go, SQL, Kafka, Airflow, PostgreSQL
- Platform & Backend Engineering: APIs, Go (Golang), Python, Distributed Systems, Platform Architecture, PostgreSQL, Microservices, Redis
- Data Platforms: Data Pipelines, Data Modeling, SQL, Apache Airflow, dbt, Kafka, Hive, Oracle
- Analytics and Observability: Apache Superset, Tableau, Grafana, BI Systems
- ML Enablement: ML-Ready Datasets, Feature Engineering, Experimentation Support

LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

Technical Leadership · Systems Thinking · Mentorship · Cross-Functional Collaboration · Globally Distributed & Remote Teams

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (B.S.), Computer Science; Minor, Mathematics
University of Wisconsin–Eau Claire, 1996 – 2000